

# News Weekly

## U.S. women's basketball team gets 70th major win in a row in FIBA World Cup quarterfinals rout

The U.S. women's basketball team won its 70th consecutive game between Olympic and FIBA World Cup play, reaching the World Cup semifinals in Berlin.

The Americans routed Hungary 108-56 in the quarterfinals, matching the program's highest point total in a World Cup knockout game. They also scored 108 points against the Soviet Union in 1986.

Napheesa Collier had a game-high 19 points, her career best in a global championship. All 12 Americans scored and played at least 10 minutes for the third time in four games.

The U.S. shot 59% from the field, including 12 of 23 (52%) from three-point range, with 31 assists on 40 buckets.

"Our chemistry just continues to build," U.S. head coach Kara Lawson said. "We're getting 10 days in now with each other.

We're starting to get a good feel. The U.S., which has won 34 consecutive games in World Cup play alone dating to 2006, gets Australia or Spain in yesterday's semifinals. (NBC)



## Mercury may be shrinking faster than scientists expected

A recent study by the German Aerospace Center's Institute of Space Research reveals that Mercury, our solar system's smallest planet, is shrinking faster than previously anticipated. The findings, published in *Geophysical Research Letters*, suggest that Mercury's diameter has decreased by up to 14 miles, a significant reduction for a planet only about 3,000 miles across. This accelerated shrinkage is attributed to the cooling and contraction of Mercury's oversized iron core, along with its mantle and crust, which tighten the surface. The study used comparative analysis of geological maps to account for hidden shrinkage wrinkles obscured by debris from impact craters. BepiColombo, a joint pair of European and Japanese spacecraft, is set to orbit Mercury soon and will utilize its laser instruments to further investigate these findings. Lead author Gaku Nishiyama, also involved in the BepiColombo mission, hopes this research will enhance our understanding of planetary evolution, particularly for contracting worlds. (NBC)



## Life uses 4 DNA letters. Scientists just made 8 work

Researchers have identified four additional sailors from Sir John Franklin's ill-fated 1845 Arctic expedition through DNA analysis, resolving a century-old mystery. Led by anthropologists at the University of Waterloo, the team matched DNA from skeletal remains with samples from living descendants. These new identifications bring the number of sailors identified by DNA to six. The expedition's two ships, *Erebus* and *Terror*, were trapped in Arctic ice by 1848, leading the surviving crew on a doomed escape attempt. Among the identified sailors is Harry Peglar, Captain of the *Foretop* on HMS *Terror*, whose identity was uncertain due to mismatched clothing found with his remains. Known as the "Peglar Papers," documents with Peglar included poetry and descriptions of the expedition's events. The other identified sailors are William Orren, David Young, and John Bridgens, confirming their survival until the desperate final escape. The findings provide descendants with new insights and resolve long-standing mysteries about the sailors' fates. (Science Daily)



## Marmot mystery: San Francisco wildlife rescue trying to return stowaway rodent home

A San Francisco wildlife rescue organization is trying to solve the mystery of how a marmot ended up in the city's Mission District. Yggdrasil Urban Wildlife Rescue said it is currently caring for a stowaway marmot that was found near 16th Street and Albion Street. The rescue organization is asking for help from residents in the area who may have recently returned from Lake Tahoe or another mountainous region. Staff members are hoping to determine how the animal arrived in San Francisco and identify where it came from. According to the rescue group, marmots are known for climbing into vehicle undercarriages, drinking radiator fluid, then passing out and later waking up in locations far from where they entered the vehicle. Rescuers hope to reunite the marmot with its home once its origin is determined. (ABC)



## Dark matter hunters may have finally spotted a hint of the particles

In June 2023, the LUX-ZEPLIN (LZ) detector may have captured a groundbreaking moment in the search for dark matter, or it could have been just an ordinary Friday. A single particle interaction detected by LZ aligns with what scientists theorize about dark matter, as reported at the TeV Particle Astrophysics meeting and on LZ's website. However, without additional data, the significance of this event remains uncertain. The scientific community is abuzz with excitement and caution. Wick Haxton from UC Berkeley describes it as the most intriguing development recently, while Dan Hooper from the University of Wisconsin-Madison urges caution, emphasizing that one event isn't enough to draw conclusions. Dark matter, a mysterious and invisible substance, influences the universe through gravity but has yet to be directly observed. LZ, located in South Dakota, aims to detect weakly interacting massive particles (WIMPs) by observing collisions in liquid xenon, which produce detectable flashes of light and electron releases. This latest analysis focuses on a theoretical form of dark matter that results in high-energy interactions. (Science News)



# Jokes

What do pigs do after school?

Their hamwork.

## Half Moon



|    |    |   |    |    |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |
|----|----|---|----|----|---|---|----|----|----|----|----|
| 12 | 6  |   | 9  |    |   | 4 |    | 7  |    | 8  |    |
|    |    |   | 8  |    |   |   |    |    | 3  |    |    |
| 4  |    |   |    |    |   |   | 1  |    | 9  |    | 12 |
| 6  |    |   |    |    | 4 |   | 9  |    |    |    |    |
| 11 | 2  |   |    |    |   | 3 | 6  | 12 | 5  |    |    |
| 3  | 9  | 4 | 12 |    |   | 8 |    | 6  |    |    | 2  |
|    |    |   |    | 2  |   | 7 |    |    |    | 1  | 6  |
|    |    | 1 |    | 10 |   |   |    |    | 12 |    |    |
| 2  |    |   |    |    | 6 | 1 | 8  |    |    |    |    |
|    | 12 |   | 5  |    |   |   | 11 |    |    | 10 |    |
| 8  |    | 2 |    |    | 9 |   | 4  |    |    |    |    |
|    |    |   |    | 1  |   |   |    |    |    | 12 | 11 |

## Wein Sumska

- 600 g Pork Belly
- - 200 g Mixed Mushrooms (e.g., cremini, oyster)
- - 50 g Dijon Mustard
- - 15 g Fresh Parsley, chopped
- - 100 ml Dry White Wine
- - 50 ml Chicken Broth
- - 15 g Garlic, minced
- - 30 ml Olive Oil
- - 5 g Salt
- - 2 g Black Pepper

1. Preheat oven to 160°C. Score the skin of the pork belly in a crisscross pattern. Season generously with salt and pepper.
2. Rub the Dijon mustard all over the pork belly, ensuring it gets into the scores.
3. Heat olive oil in an oven-safe pan over medium-high heat. Sear the pork belly skin-side down for 8-10 minutes until golden and crispy.
4. Flip the pork belly and sear for another 5 minutes. Transfer the pan to the preheated oven and roast for 60 minutes.
5. While the pork roasts, clean and slice the mixed mushrooms. In a separate pan, sauté minced garlic in a little olive oil until fragrant.
6. Add the sliced mushrooms to the pan with garlic and cook until they release their moisture and start to brown.
7. Deglaze the mushroom pan with white wine, scraping up any browned bits. Add the chicken broth and simmer for 5 minutes.
8. Remove the pork belly from the oven. Let it rest for 10 minutes before slicing into thick pieces.
9. Stir the chopped fresh parsley into the mushroom sauce. Taste and adjust seasoning if needed.
10. Serve the sliced pork belly alongside the warm mushroom sauce.

